

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Using silence as pressure, punishment, superiority, or a way to make the other person feel uncomfortable

THE MOVE

Meaningful moment + warm pause + one useful next move. -> Say the key sentence, pause, let them continue, then reflect or ask one useful question. -> "That sounds like it mattered." [pause] "What part is still with you?" -> "My ?

START HERE

Say the key sentence or question, then pause warmly for one slow breath before speaking again.

SAY THIS

Supportive pause op...	"Take your time."
After emotion	"That sounds like it hit hard."
After a question	"What was the real issue there? [pause]"
Professional	"I will pause there because that is the key trade-off."
Conflict / tension	"I hear the concern. [pause]"
High-status / busy	"I will keep it brief and pause there."

AVOID

- Immediate safety or operational urgency requires clear action.
- The person already feels abandoned, embarrassed, confused, or put on the spot.
- You would be using silence to punish, dominate, extract, test, or create discomfort.

REMEMBER

If the moment has weight, do not remove it with words.